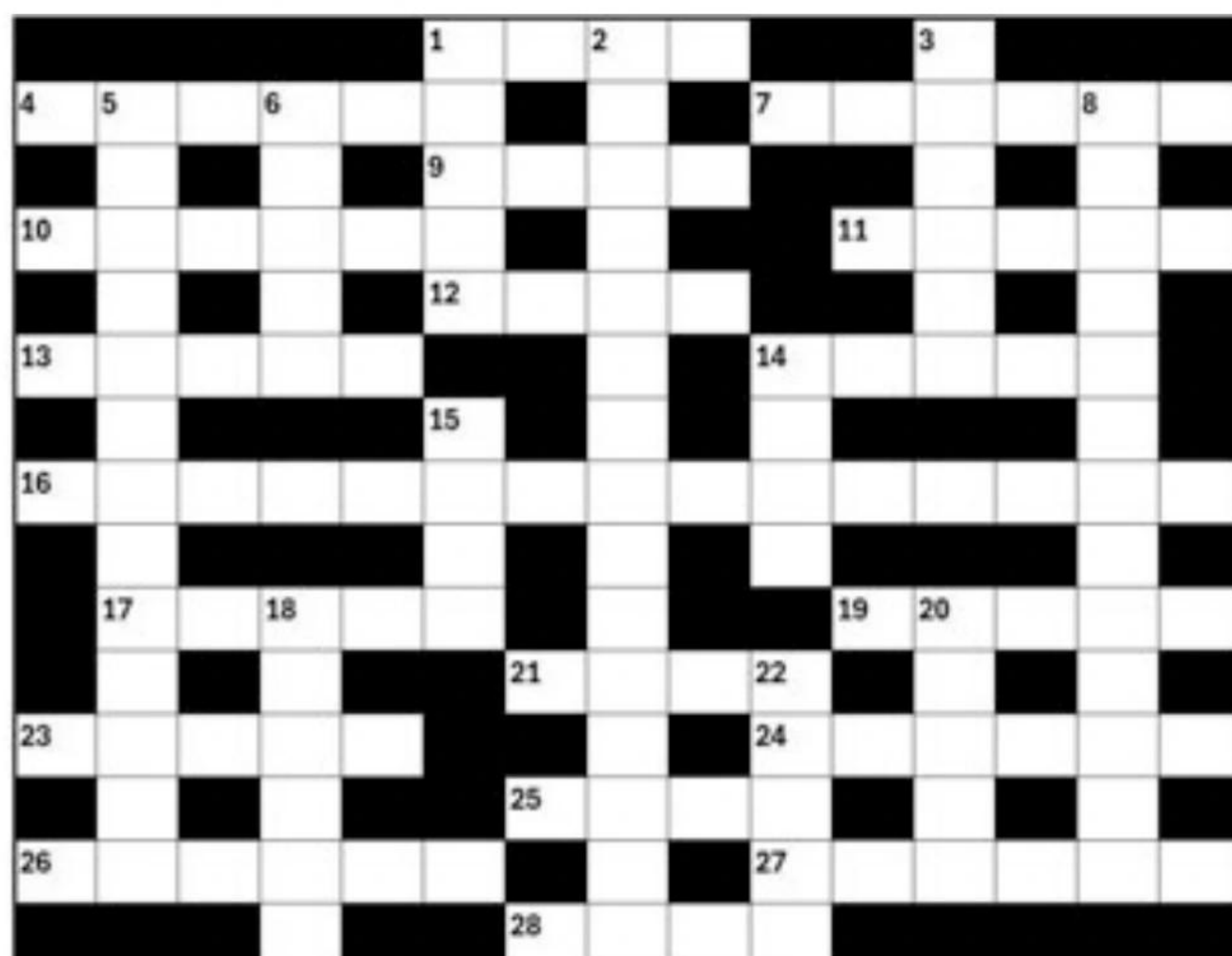


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

ACROSS

- 1 FTB: F1 circuit lengths are normally broken into ____ that drivers go around. (4)
- 4 Identify the surname of this player from Brentford who scored a hat-trick in the Premier league encounter versus Bournemouth on December 27, 2025. (6)
- 7 Identify the surname of this cricketer who won the Player of the Final award in the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy of the 2024-25 season. (6)
- 9 Identify the surname of this professional racing driver who, in 2022, became the first Indian to be invited to the Ferrari Driver Academy (FDA) Asia-Pacific selection region. (4)
- 10 Identify the first name of this cricketer who, in 2023, became the first batter to score centuries in the final of two consecutive ICC tournaments. (6)
- 11 Identify the first name of this former World Billiards champion from India who passed away on January 5, 2026. (5)
- 12 Identify the surname of the footballer who has already scored more than 30 goals in the Bundesliga of the current season. (4)
- 13 Identify the surname of this Indian shooter who won the gold medal along with Arjun Babuta for the 10m air rifle mixed team event at the World Cup held in Munich in 2025. (5)
- 14 Identify the first name of India's men's hockey team coach. (5)
- 16 Which team won the Pro-Wrestling

- League (PWL) in February 2026. (7,8)
- 17 Identify the first name of the cricketer who became the first woman to take a wicket off her first ball in T20Is. (5)
- 19 FTB : ____ is a powerful, downward attacking shot used to win rallies in badminton. (5)
- 21 Identify one of the nicknames of Indian cricket legend Rahul Dravid. (4)
- 23 What is a game in snooker called? (5)
- 24 Identify the first name of this footballer who scored a hat-trick for TSG Hoffenheim in the Bundesliga match against Borussia Monchengladbach on January 14, 2026. (6)
- 25 Who is the most capped footballer of the Brazilian national team? (4)
- 26 Identify the first name of this footballer who scored a hat-trick for VFL Wolfsburg in the Bundesliga encounter versus SC Freiburg on December 20, 2025. (5)
- 27 FTB: Ranchi _____ finished as runner-up in the Hockey India League held in January 2026. (6)
- 28 Identify the first name of this Indian women's cricketer from Karnataka who retired from all forms of the game in July 2025. (4)

DOWN

- 1 Identify the surname of the player who won the Player of the Match award in the 2026 T20 World Cup match between Scotland and Italy. (5)
- 2 Who won the Player of the Match award in the 2026 T20 World Cup match between Sri Lanka and Oman. (5,10)
- 3 Which State football team finished as

runner-up in the recently-concluded Santosh Trophy? (6)

- 5 Who, on February 1, 2026, became the youngest tennis player in the world to complete a career Grand Slam? (6,7)
- 6 Identify the surname of this Brazilian footballer nicknamed "O Magnata" who, at the age of 49 in 2025, came back from retirement to play alongside his son for Atletico Cearense. (5)
- 8 Who won the 2026 season opening Australian F1 GP? (6,7)
- 14 Identify the surname of the Brazilian middle distance runner who won the 800m event at the Los Angeles Olympics in 1984. (4)
- 15 Identify the first name of the first Indian female hockey player to win the Arjuna Award in 1961. (4)
- 18 Identify the first name of this Spanish footballer who scored a hat-trick for Barcelona in the La Liga league match against Villarreal. (6)
- 20 Identify the surname of this English cricketer who became the first player to score 1000 runs in Twenty20 cricket. (5)
- 22 Identify the first name of this South African team captain who, in June 2024, became the third woman cricketer to score a century in all three formats of the game. (5)